

Mitchell decided to separate from his wife, he had clearly not thought through the devastating cost to his family or to himself. He was so hell-bent on pursuing what he thought would be his personal happiness that he had destroyed everything he had worked so hard to build.

“He took Judy for granted,” Linda said. “He threw away his family dynasty. There’s no coming back from that.”

And that’s when it hit me how right Linda was. The family dynasty was the heart of everything—home, happiness, financial security and freedom. It was essential: a dynasty that is grown carefully and prudently over many years, first between two partners, then expanding to include kids, relatives and other families. Over the coming months, that idea would percolate, taking on more substance until it eventually became this book.



What is a family dynasty? By my definition, a dynasty is not just the people you are related to by blood. It encompasses all the significant relationships in your life. In addition to your parents, siblings and kids, there are the business relationships that enable you to build your fortune. There are the friends and family who act as a support system and network, both personal and professional. Over your lifetime, you will constantly invest capital in other people, whether that capital is money, resources or time. Each of these relationships has a role in building and preserving your family dynasty.

Anybody can have a family, but growing a dynasty requires a special kind of diligence and commitment and results in a solid financial and emotional gain over time. I like to think of a family as the largest asset base you’ll ever build. In this book, I urge you to treat your dynasty as a long-term financial asset. Forming a family is in some ways similar to setting up a business. Like any business, your family will have different attributes and assets: some emotional, some financial. Take, for example, the investment you make in your children’s education: when you send a son or daughter off to university or trade school, you’re strengthening the